

How to Write an AP Human Geography FRQ

Writing an FRQ is different from other types of writing.

- You do not need a thesis statement, topic sentences or conclusion
- You MUST write in complete sentences for credit
 - Even if your answer is correct, you will not receive credit if it is not a complete sentence
- You ANSWER the questions based on the verb
 - The verb will guide you as to how many sentences you will write.
 - Identify: One sentence
 - Define: One sentence
 - Explain/Describe/Compare/Contrast: Three-four sentences
 - Compare: Provide a description or explanation of similarities and/or differences.
 - Define: Provide a specific meaning for a word or concept.
 - Describe: Provide the relevant characteristics of a specified topic.
 - Explain: Provide information about how or why a relationship, process, pattern, position, or outcome occurs, using evidence and/or reasoning.
 - Identify: Indicate or provide information about a specified topic, without elaboration or explanation.
- Plan out your writing in a quick draft
 - Bullet points
 - Carefully analyze the question: think about what is being asked and identify the elements that must be addressed in the response.
 - For example, some questions may require you to consider the similarities between people or events, and then to think of the ways they are different. Others may ask you to develop an argument with examples to support it.
 - Be sure to answer exactly what is being asked in the question prompt!
- Label your FRQ sections: A, B, C, E, F, etc.
- Skip a line between the FRQ sections
 - When you do this, you make it easier on the person reading your responses to score (not grade). There is a difference.
- You may answer out of order.
 - If you know the answer to Part C but not Part B, answer C first BUT label
- You may not double dip from one section to another.
- For anything other than a define/identify question:
 - Identify your answer
 - Provide evidence/examples to your response
 - Then explain why it is an example
 - Do not use obscure references for your examples
 - Go with the most obvious example

From the minds of Ferguson, Frazier and CB:)

<https://apstudents.collegeboard.org/courses/ap-human-geography/exam-tips>